



Guess what, there's a bird that looks majestic and elegant, just like it stepped out of a fairy tale! That's right, we're talking about the heron, a tall and slender bird with a long, pointy beak. These beautiful creatures come in many different colors, from pure white to dark blue, and they have long, thin legs that they use to wade through water. The heron's wings are broad and rounded, allowing it to glide gracefully through the sky.

Gliding from the sky, they dip their beaks into water and grab a tasty meal. Herons are carnivores, which means they love to eat meat. Their diet mainly consists of fish, but they also enjoy chomping on frogs, small mammals, and even other birds! Their long, sharp beak is perfect for catching and eating their prey.

From fish-filled waters, let's move to where these fascinating birds choose to live. Herons can be found in wetlands all over the world, from the swamps of Florida to the rivers of Africa. They build their nests high up in trees, safe from predators and close to their food source. These nests can be quite large, often housing several heron chicks at once.



Speaking of chicks, let's take a quick peek into the life cycle of a heron. After a female heron lays her eggs, both parents take turns sitting on the nest to keep the eggs warm. When the chicks hatch, they're cared for by both parents until they're old enough to leave the nest and fend for themselves. And guess what, these wonderful birds can live up to 15 years in the wild!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) What colors can herons be?
A. Only brown
B. Only gray or black
C. Only orange
D. White to dark blue
- 2) What type of a beak does a heron have?
A. A square beak
B. No beak at all
C. A long, pointy beak
D. A short, curved beak
- 3) Which is a kind of animals herons prey on?
A. Bears
B. Dogs
C. Elephants
D. Fish
- 4) What do herons do after laying their eggs?
A. They put them in a pouch on their belly
B. They leave the eggs
C. They bury the eggs
D. They sit on them
- 5) How long do herons typically live?
A. Up to 15 years
B. Up to 50 years
C. Only 1 year
D. Over 100 years
- 6) What do herons eat?
A. Seeds
B. Fruits
C. Leaves
D. Meat
- 7) Where do herons build their nests?
A. Underground
B. High up in trees
C. In the ocean
D. On the ground
- 8) Where are you most likely to find herons?
A. In jungles
B. In mountains
C. In Wetlands
D. In deserts
- 9) What type of diet to herons have?
A. They are herbivores
B. They are carnivores
C. They are fruitivores
D. They are omnivores
- 10) Who cares for the heron chicks?
A. Only the father
B. Other birds
C. Only the mother
D. Both parents

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "My chicks need to fend for themselves right after they hatch."
- 12) "Fish are my favorite food!"
- 13) "I nest in tall trees. It keeps me safe from predators, and close to my food."
- 14) "My nest can house several heron chicks. It's quite spacious you know."
- 15) "I can have feathers ranging from pure white to dark blue."
- 16) "I can't fly and spend most of my time on the ground."
- 17) "My diet mainly includes fruits and seeds."
- 18) "We are a common sight in wetlands all around the world!"
- 19) "I keep my eggs on the ground, they're safer there."

- 20) "I am a small bird."
- 21) "I'm a carnivore. Meat is what I love to eat."
- 22) "I am a herbivore and love eating plants."
- 23) "Fish are my favorite meal, but when there is a chance, I gobble up frogs and even smaller animals."
- 24) "Both mom and dad play a role in bringing up the kids, that's how it goes in our family."
- 25) "I have a short life span of 3 to 5 years."
- 26) "I can live up to 15 years. Quite a long time, huh?"
- 27) "My pointy beak is great for getting fish."
- 28) "I prefer living in dry, desert areas."
- 29) "I rarely go into the water."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 30) Herons can be found in wetlands around the globe.
- 31) Herons are the most beautiful birds in the world with their long legs, slender necks, and elegant beaks.
- 32) Herons eat frogs, mammals, and other birds.
- 33) The way herons gracefully glide through the sky is the most beautiful sight to watch.
- 34) Herons have long, thin legs.
- 35) Herons are the coolest because they can eat anything from small mammals to frogs and fish!
- 36) Herons build their nests up high in trees.
- 37) Herons eat fish as part of their diet.
- 38) The fact that herons can live up to 15 years in the wild is amazing.
- 39) The best thing about herons is they are expert fish catchers.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 40) Male and female heron take turns sitting on the eggs.
- 41) After hatching, heron chicks are on their own.
- 42) Herons hunt for food by dipping their beaks in the water.
- 43) Herons eat only goldfish.
- 44) Herons can live up to 15 years in the wild.
- 45) Herons can be found in deserts around the globe.
- 46) Herons have short, stubby beaks.
- 47) Herons mainly eat plants and seeds.
- 48) Herons may be found in wetlands all around the world.
- 49) Herons are carnivores.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 50)** Herons don't build nests on the ground, they build them in trees.
A. doesn't
B. do not
C. can't
D. isn't
- 51)** The heron won't fly away.
A. will not
B. isn't
C. can not
D. didn't

52) There's a heron standing by the pond.

- A. There has
C. There was
- B. There does
D. There is

53) You're likely to spot a heron near water bodies.

- A. You are B. You have
C. You does D. You was

54) I've seen a heron hunting for fish.

- A. I does
B. I is
C. I have
D. I was

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

55) Herons can stand still for a long time while waiting for their prey.

56) Herons have been known to choke on fish that are too large - what a risky meal!

57) A group of herons is called a siege, it's a quirky name!

58) The heron's long and thin legs are perfect for wading into water, it's absolutely ingenious!

59) Herons nest in groups called heronries, which can include hundreds of birds - it's astonishing!

60) Herons have long beaks that they use to catch their food.

61) Can herons swim?

62) Black herons use their wings to make an umbrella, creating shade and attracting fish - they're genius!

63) Herons build their nests in trees or on the ground.

64) What are the different species of herons?

65) The largest heronries can span several acres and include thousands of nests - it's quite a spectacle!

66) Are herons solitary birds?

67) Some herons, like the Boat-Billed Heron, are night hunters - the variety is truly surprising!

68) Herons have necks that can snap forward like a springtrap to catch their prey - such a clever hunting method!

69) Great blue herons can live up to 15 years - That's longer than most dog breeds!

70) Herons can spend up to 90% of their day feeding, that's some serious commitment!



- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | 68. _____ |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | 69. _____ |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | 70. _____ |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	D	26.	Would	51.	A
2.	C	27.	Would	52.	D
3.	D	28.	Not	53.	A
4.	D	29.	Not	54.	C
5.	A	30.	fact	55.	declarative
6.	D	31.	opinion	56.	exclamatory
7.	B	32.	fact	57.	exclamatory
8.	C	33.	opinion	58.	exclamatory
9.	B	34.	fact	59.	exclamatory
10.	D	35.	opinion	60.	declarative
11.	Not	36.	fact	61.	interrogative
12.	Would	37.	fact	62.	exclamatory
13.	Would	38.	opinion	63.	declarative
14.	Would	39.	opinion	64.	interrogative
15.	Would	40.	true	65.	exclamatory
16.	Not	41.	false	66.	interrogative
17.	Not	42.	true	67.	exclamatory
18.	Would	43.	false	68.	exclamatory
19.	Not	44.	true	69.	exclamatory
20.	Not	45.	false	70.	exclamatory
21.	Would	46.	false		
22.	Not	47.	false		
23.	Would	48.	true		
24.	Would	49.	true		
25.	Not	50.	B		